

MISSION MADHYA PRADESH CM Dr Mohan Yadav (middle) with India Today Group's Raj Chengappa (right) and Sayeed Ansari (left)

Photograph by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

"WE HAVE MADE **COLLECTORS RESPONSIBLE FOR ALL PERMISSIONS** BY CREATING AN INDUSTRIES CELL SO THAT ALL PERMISSIONS CAN BE SECURED AT ONE POINT"

MOHAN YADAV, Chief Minister, Madhya Pradesh

In a state known for its numerous women-centric initiatives, minister Pratima Bagri shared her journey in politics, while Sufiyah Faruqui, Commissioner, Women and Child Development, highlighted the latest welfare interventions. In a session on manufacturing, Nidhi Agrawal, representing the MSME sector, spoke about the kind of policy support she expected from the government—particularly in securing talent. Aditya Shrivastava of Volvo Eicher discussed the company's massive investments in Madhya Pradesh, especially in next-generation technologies, including electric vehicles.

Start-ups based in MP, represented by Gaurav Rana, Anurag Asati and Prashant Mishra, also shared their journeys and outlined what is needed to make startups more successful. Tourism, another key sector identified for growth, was the subject of a session wherein the policy initiatives were listed by the department's Principal Secretary Sheo Shekhar Shukla, with Bagheli culinary expert and former minister Pushpraj Singh, MLA Nitendra Singh Rathore and wildlifer Ali Rashid mentioning what they expected from the state's policy. As the discussions on sectoral growth wrapped up, attention shifted to the political landscape. A feisty MP Congress chief Jitendra (Jitu) Patwari spoke of his plans to revive the party ahead of the assembly election slated for 2028.

As classical vocalist Gautam Kale set the tone for the day with his insights into the intricacies of music with a couple of short performances, popular telly heartthrob Vivian D'Sena entertained the audience with a little jig while also narrating his journey from small town Ujjain to the world of television in Mumbai. Standup comic Aditya Kulshreshth, known for his acute observations on life in Bhopal, had the audience in splits. ■